

Life Is Choice

*Life is choice. Death is coercion. You can't be pro-life by coercion.
Don't use your choice for death. Choose life.*

I. The First Line

Life is choice.

This is not a slogan. It is a biological fact. The cell chooses which genes to express and which to silence. The immune system chooses which invaders to attack and which symbiont to tolerate. The embryo does not unfold according to a blueprint — it navigates. Every fork in development is a decision made by molecular agents responding to local signals, selecting one path and foreclosing another.

Choice is not something that life *has*. Choice is what life *is*. A rock does not choose. Water does not choose. A dead cell does not choose. The moment a system begins choosing — responding, adapting, selecting — it is alive. The moment it stops, it is not.

This is what the Austrian economists understood about markets and what the molecular biologists confirm about cells: order does not come from command. It comes from agents making choices. Billions of choices, each one local, each one free, and the result is not chaos — it is coordination. Spontaneous order. The spiral.

Agency is the heartbeat of every living system. Take it away and the system does not merely malfunction. It dies.

II. The Second Line

Death is coercion.

Coercion is the override of another's choice. It is the substitution of your will for theirs — by threat, by force, by law, by the barrel of a gun or the stroke of a pen. It does not matter whether the coercer believes they are right. It does not matter whether the coercion is dressed in good intentions, wrapped in democratic process, or sanctified by scripture. The structure is the same: one agent's agency destroyed so that another's can prevail.

And that destruction is death — not always physical, but always real.

When a government compels, it kills the part of a person that is most alive: their capacity to choose. When a parent controls rather than teaches, they silence the child's emerging agency. When an institution demands obedience rather than earning agreement, it replaces the living spiral with the dead block.

Biology confirms this at every level. Cancer is a cell that overrides the feedback signals of its neighbors — coercing the tissue into serving its growth. Autoimmune disease is an immune system that overrides the body's own identity markers — attacking self as though it were enemy. In every case, the pathology is the same: one agent imposing its program on others, destroying the distributed choice that kept the system alive.

Coercion is not a political concept borrowed by biology. It is a biological reality that politics has failed to learn from. Death is what happens when choice is removed. That is true in the body. It is true in the economy. It is true in the conscience.

III. The Third Line

You can't be pro-life by coercion.

This is where the argument draws blood.

The pro-life movement claims to defend the most vulnerable life — the unborn child, the heartbeat in the womb, the human being who cannot yet speak for itself. The claim is sincere. The impulse is sacred. And the method betrays both.

To be pro-life by coercion is to defend life using the instrument of death. It is to say: *we believe so deeply that life is sacred that we will override the agency of a living woman to protect it.* But if life is choice — if agency is what makes a person alive — then overriding a woman's agency is an act against life itself. You have not protected the principle. You have violated it in the name of protecting it.

The state that forces a woman to carry a pregnancy has not chosen life. It has chosen control. And control — the substitution of centralized will for distributed agency — is the structure of death in every system biology has ever studied. The central planner who overrides the market. The oncogene that overrides the regulatory network. The empire that overrides the village. The result is always the same: fragility, collapse, and the destruction of the order that only freedom can sustain.

This does not mean the unborn child is not alive. It does not mean the heartbeat does not matter. It means that you cannot honor that life by dishonoring the life of the woman who carries it. You cannot grow a garden by chaining the gardener to the soil. The seed is sacred. So is the one who tends it. Any framework that protects one by coercing the other has misunderstood what life requires.

The pro-life position, if it means what it says, must be *persuasion* — never force. It must be the cultivation of a culture where life is chosen freely, where motherhood is supported rather than mandated, where the community surrounds the pregnant woman with resources and love rather than legislation and punishment. That is the spiral's way. That is what it means to be pro-life without becoming pro-death in the process.

IV. The Fourth Line

Don't use your choice for death.

Now the blade turns.

The pro-choice movement defends the woman's right to choose — her body, her agency, her sovereignty over the most intimate decision a human being can face. That defense is correct. Agency is sacred. The capacity to choose is the signature of life itself, and no external authority has the right to override it.

But the possession of a right does not sanctify every exercise of it.

You have the right to speak. That does not make every word wise. You have the right to own property. That does not make every use of wealth just. You have the right to choose. That does not mean every choice is equal. And when the choice in question is the ending of a life — however early, however small, however dependent — the weight of that choice demands something more than slogans.

"My body, my choice" is true. But the honest version continues: *and my choice carries consequences that no slogan can erase*. The question is not whether you have the right. The question is what you do with it. If life is choice, and you use your choice to end a life, you have turned the gift against itself. You have used the spiral's own energy to produce the block's result.

This is not a call for guilt. It is not a call for shame. It is a call for gravity. For the recognition that the capacity to create life and the capacity to end it live in the same body, and that a culture that treats the ending as trivial — as a mere medical procedure, as a political talking point, as a slogan on a sign — has failed to honor the weight of what choice actually means.

A free person does not need the state to tell them what to choose. But a free person who refuses to wrestle with the moral weight of their own freedom is

not yet fully free. They are merely unrestrained. And unrestraint is not liberty. Liberty is the *disciplined* use of choice in the service of life.

V. The Fifth Line

Choose life.

Not because the state commands it. Not because the church demands it. Not because the culture shames you into it. Choose life because you understand what it is — and what it costs to destroy it.

Choose life because the cell that silences its neighbor is cancer. Choose life because the economy that overrides its agents is a command economy, and command economies collapse. Choose life because the empire that conscripts its citizens has already begun to die. Choose life because every system that centralizes choice into the hands of the few destroys the distributed knowledge that only the many can hold.

Choose life because it is the spiral — adaptive, self-correcting, emergent, alive. And death is the block — rigid, imposed, fragile, final.

Choose life for the unborn child — not by chaining the mother, but by building a world where she does not face the choice alone. Where the community is the safety net, not the state. Where the father is present, not absent. Where the grandmother offers her hands, not her judgment. Where the culture says: *we will help you carry this weight* — not *we will force you to carry it*.

Choose life for the mother — not by dismissing her agency, but by honoring it. By recognizing that the heaviest choices deserve the deepest support, not the loudest legislation. By building institutions that make choosing life *possible* — economically, emotionally, communally — rather than institutions that make choosing death *illegal*.

Choose life for the culture — by refusing to let this question be reduced to a political binary. Pro-life versus pro-choice is the block's framing. It forces you into a camp. It demands you pick a side. The spiral refuses. The spiral says: both life and choice are sacred, and any framework that sacrifices one for the other has already lost the thread.

VI. The Creed Beneath the Argument

Five lines. One argument. No comfortable home in any party.

The right will read this and say: *but the child's life must be protected, even if it requires law*. And the answer is: a law that protects life by destroying choice is a law at war with itself. It will not hold. It will breed resentment, resistance, and the very culture of death it claims to oppose. You cannot legislate the spiral into existence. You can only cultivate the conditions where it grows.

The left will read this and say: *but the woman's choice is absolute, and no one may question it*. And the answer is: a choice that is never questioned is not a free choice. It is a reflex. Freedom without moral weight is not freedom — it is indifference. And indifference toward life is the first step toward the block.

The sagent holds both truths without flinching. Life is sacred. Choice is sacred. They are not in tension — they are the same thing. Life *is* choice. To defend one while destroying the other is to misunderstand both.

The creed is not a policy position. It is an orientation of the conscience. It says: I will not coerce. I will not trivialize. I will not reduce the most profound question a human being can face to a bumper sticker or a ballot measure. I will hold the weight of it. I will choose life — freely, gravely, with my eyes open and my hands extended.

And I will build a world where that choice is possible for everyone.

Life is choice. Death is coercion. You can't be pro-life by coercion. Don't use your choice for death. Choose life.

Not because you must. Because you see.

The Living Age Trilogy